

Silent Letters

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 6 English — Spelling / Phonics

ACARA v9.0: AC9E6LY08

Learning Intention

I am learning to use phonic knowledge of less common grapheme-phoneme relationships, including silent letters, to read and spell complex words.

Success Criteria

- I can identify the silent letter in a word.
- I can sort words by their silent letter pattern.
- I can spell words with silent letters correctly.

Heard But Not Seen (or Seen But Not Heard!)

A silent letter is written but not pronounced. Common patterns: kn- (knee), wr- (write), -mb (comb), gh (night), -sc (scissors).

Worked Example

Word: 'knight'

Silent letters: k and gh

Say it: /nite/ — the k and gh are not heard.

Part A — Warm Up

Circle the silent letter in 'knee': **k n e**

True or False: Every letter in 'island' is pronounced. _____

Write the silent letter in 'write'. _____

Part B — Core Skills

Sort into their silent letter pattern: *comb, knife, wrist, sign, gnome, thumb*

Group / Column 1	Group / Column 2

Circle the correctly spelled word: **sis**sors
scissors **sc**isors

Write 2 more words with a silent 'k' like 'knee'.

1. _____ 2. _____

Explain why silent letters can make English spelling tricky, using 'gh' in 'night' as your example.

Silent Letter Word Bank

knee • write • comb • sign • gnome • scissors • thumb • night • wrist • island

Working Space — Write 5 Words with Silent Letters and Circle the Silent Letter in Each

Silent Letters — Page 2

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 6 English — Spelling / Phonics

ACARA v9.0: AC9E6LY08

Part C — Challenge: The Spelling Bee

In a Year 6 spelling bee, a student was asked to spell 'foreign'. They wrote 'forein', missing a silent letter.

Q8. Identify which silent letter the student missed, and write the correct spelling.

Q9. Write 2 other commonly misspelled words that contain silent letters.

Q10. Explain a strategy the student could use to remember silent letters in tricky words like 'foreign'.

Answer Key — Part A

A1: k

A2: False — the 's' in 'island' is silent and not pronounced.

A3: w

Answer Key — Part B

B1: -mb: comb, thumb. Silent k: knife. Silent w: wrist.
Silent g: sign, gnome.

B2: scissors

B3: Any 2 correct silent 'k' words (e.g. knight, know, knot) — teacher to check.

B4: The 'gh' in 'night' is written but not pronounced at all, so students must remember to include it from memory rather than by sounding the word out, which makes spelling less predictable.

Answer Key — Part C

C8: The student missed the silent 'g'. Correct spelling: foreign.

C9: Any 2 reasonable silent letter words (e.g. 'science', 'Wednesday', 'listen') — teacher to check.

C10: Any reasonable spelling strategy (e.g. breaking the word into chunks, using mnemonics, or practising the word multiple times) — teacher to check.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can identify silent letters in words.

☐ I can spell words with silent letters correctly.

☐ I can sort words by silent letter pattern.